appearance of a character I really wanted to draw again. That was very exciting, but it can be daunting to draw all of the Batcave.

**You'll have other DC characters to draw soon, as Superman will be testing his new power against the Justice League in an issue you're writing. Is that correct?**
He will be trying it out against the Justice League, yes. I know the basic idea for that issue, but not specifically which characters will be in it. At this stage, it's an idea we are still developing. That's #40, and I'm just finishing up #39 right now. But those two issues are the bridge to our next big story arc, and there will be repercussions from the changes we've introduced. A big change is coming up with Clark Kent/Superman, but I can't tell you about that yet. I'm plotting #40, I know that, and as far as doing the dialogue goes I'll see how the time works out.

**That's the other recent announcement, of course, that Geoff Johns is leaving the book, to be replaced by Gene Luen Yang. What will he bring to the character?**
I can't tell you, I have to keep my mouth shut [laughs]. All I will say is that the storyline covering all of the Superman books is in great hands. I just sit back and draw whatever they give me.

**Are you upset about Geoff leaving? He has so many film and TV commitments, it must be hard for him to write comics...**
These guys taking off for Hollywood, how can he choose [laughs]? I think he is still writing *Justice League*, though.

**Working with him, did he ever tell you about what he had coming up? Did he show you the script for *Batman v Superman: Dawn Of Justice*, for example?**
He didn't, but I'm really looking forward to that. I think Ben Affleck is a hell of an actor, I think he'll pull it off. And honestly, people are asking me now, "How can it be Batman against Superman? Superman is going to tear his head off!" And I say, "You've got to watch it."

**You must be excited about the Marvel/Sony deal too, allowing Spider-Man to star in some of the Marvel movies, considering your history with the character...**
Yes, they are connecting Spider-Man to the rest of the Marvel universe onscreen, and I think that's great, I'm very happy for them. The fans have been waiting for that for a long time. Every superhero and comic-book has the ability to work well as a movie, and when it does then that's good for all of us. It's a genre that has longevity, and if you have ideas, the creative talent and the stories, you can make it happen as live action. It's something here for the long haul.

**Wasn't Spider-Man your introduction to comics? When your father was drawing it, didn't you design a character, the Prowler, for him?**
I came up with the name, but the costume I designed was so awful. Even Stan Lee in his pleasantness said [adopts Stan voice], "Hate the costume, love the name." So they kept the name, and he looked nothing like the version I did, but they did give me credit for it when I was 13.

**One of your great *Spider-Man* stories was the 9/11 issue, addressing how the character felt about that happening in his city. Is it one that still resonates with you?**
Yeah, it does. I have a hard time... honestly, I haven't even opened up that issue since about 2002. I can't look at it. I have the original artwork in my safe here and I don't know what I'm going to do with it. Maybe one day I'll donate it, perhaps to a 9/11 charity. But I don't know what to do with the artwork. I'm holding onto it, I've been offered amazing amounts of money for it, I can't conceive of selling it for a profit unless it's for an emergency, I don't know, I honestly don't know. But I can't look at it... it breaks me up.

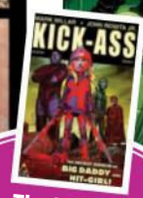
> "IT'S A GENRE THAT HAS LONGEVITY, AND IF YOU HAVE IDEAS... YOU CAN MAKE IT HAPPEN"
> JOHN ROMITA JR




**The artist is excited at what's ahead for the likes of Spider-Man.**




**Romita Jr has gained an even wider audience via his work on *Kick-Ass*.**




**The best of John Romita Jr**
**Kick-Ass (2008)**
Before the original movie, *Kick-Ass* was just a miniseries with Romita Jr's art and Mark Millar's writing. Spawned two sequels and a *Hit Girl* prequel.





**He has also presided over some interesting new changes to Superman.**



**The best of John Romita Jr**
**The Amazing Spider-Man Vol 2 30-58 (2001-03)**
Romita Jr first drew Spider-Man in the Eighties, but teaming him up with *Babylon 5* creator J Michael Straczynski years later breathed new life into him.